

Upload kit — Costco \$1.50 hot dog

Final video: `final/costco-hot-dog-final-1080p.mp4` — 1920×1080, 30 fps, H.264 + AAC, 8:19 (narration 8:07 + 12 s end-screen hold). Over 8:00, so mid-roll ads can be turned on.

Chosen title

Why Is a Costco Hot Dog Only \$1.50? — thumbnail: `thumbnails/warehouse-still150-v2.jpg` (final pick). No brand logo; "COSTCO" in plain lettering.

Earlier title + thumbnail options (for reference)

#	Title	Thumbnail	Best for
3 ★ recommended	Costco's Co-Founder Threatened to 'Kill' Over a \$1.50 Hot Dog	<code>thumbnails/thumb3-dont-you-dare.jpg</code> — angry co-founder pointing at you, "DON'T YOU DARE." + \$1.50 sign	Curiosity / clicks. The video pays this off at 0:11 , so viewers who click get what they came for right away (good for retention).
1	Why Costco Will Never Raise the Price of Its \$1.50 Hot Dog	<code>thumbnails/thumb1-still-150.jpg</code> — shocked mascot, "STILL \$1.50?! SINCE 1985"	Search — matches what people type ("costco hot dog price"). Safest, Inkly-style "Why..." title.
2	Costco Loses Money on Its \$1.50 Hot Dog... On Purpose	<code>thumbnails/thumb2-on-purpose.jpg</code> — smirking mascot, crashing red arrow, "LOSING MONEY ON PURPOSE?!"	The business-strategy angle; promises the twist (membership).

Title rules used: under 60 characters, "Costco" + "\$1.50 hot dog" in every title for search, thumbnail text adds to the title instead of repeating it, ≤ 4 big words on the thumbnail so it reads on a phone.

If YouTube Studio shows **Test & compare** for your channel, upload all three thumbnails and let YouTube pick the winner.

Description (paste)

The Costco hot dog has cost \$1.50 since 1985. A top Costco executive once pushed to raise it — and co-founder Jim Sinegal's answer became business legend. Here's the real reason the price never moves (it was never about the hot dog).

Chapters 0:00 The \$1.50 paradox 0:52 A price frozen in time 1:47 "Figure it out" 3:07 Rebuilding the hot dog 4:33 The real product 5:47 The \$400 million chicken 7:05 What the hot dog really costs 7:42 Next: New Coke

Sources - Costco Wholesale Corp., Form 10-K for fiscal year 2025: total revenue \$275.2B, membership fees \$5.32B, operating income ~\$10.4B, renewal rate 92.3% (U.S. & Canada). SEC EDGAR. - Costco food court sales of 245.1 million hot dog and soda combos in fiscal 2025 — reported by Mashed, Chowhound and AOL from Costco's annual report. - Original 1985 combo (quarter-pound hot dog + 12 oz can of soda) vs. today (10% bigger hot dog + 20 oz fountain soda with refills) — KOMO News, Chowhound. - Craig Jelinek's account of Jim Sinegal's "Figure it out" response (told to 425 Business, 2018; Jelinek was CEO 2012–2023) — Business Insider, Today, Fox Business. - Costco's switch from Hebrew National to Kirkland Signature hot dogs (2009) and its own hot dog plants in Tracy, California, and Morris, Illinois (second plant from 2018) — Food Republic, The Takeout, Chowhound. - Costco's switch from Coca-Cola to Pepsi (2013, to cut costs and protect the \$1.50 price) and back to Coca-Cola (announced by CEO Ron Vachris Jan. 23, 2025; rolled out summer 2025) — ABC News affiliates, Progressive Grocer, Reader's Digest. - Jim Sinegal's "heroin" comparison on raising prices — as recounted by Eric Ries; Yahoo Finance. - Costco's 14% / 15% markup cap — widely reported; Yahoo Finance. - Rotisserie chicken at \$4.99 since 2009, Richard Galanti on being "willing to eat... \$30 to \$40 million a year in gross margin" (Seattle Times, 2015), and the \$400–450 million Nebraska poultry complex in Fremont (opened Sept. 2019, built for up to 2 million chickens/week) — KSL / CNN, WATTAgNet, Meatingplace, Supermarket News. - New Coke launched April 1985 after winning blind taste tests; withdrawn within ~3 months (bridge teaser — full sourcing in the New Coke video). - 2026 combo update (from April 2026) adding a 16.9 oz Kirkland Signature bottled-water option at the same \$1.50 — Axios (May 2026), Boing Boing, Cheapism. - 157.4 million rotisserie chickens sold in fiscal 2025, per Costco's annual shareholder report — Tasting Table, AOL. - Inflation adjustment: \$1.50 in 1985 ≈ \$4.66 in 2026 (BLS CPI 107.6 → ~334) — U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics CPI data.

Tags

costco hot dog, costco \$1.50 hot dog, costco hot dog price, why costco hot dog is 1.50, costco business strategy, costco membership, costco rotisserie chicken, jim sinegal, craig jelinek, business stories, loss leader

After upload

- **End screen** (last ~12 s): video tile on the right side where the mascot points + subscribe button. Until the New Coke video is live, use "Best for viewer" and swap it later.
- Turn on **mid-roll ads** (video is over 8:00); let YouTube place them automatically for now.
- Optional: add quiet background music from YouTube Studio → Audio Library.
- Check **Analytics** → **Audience retention** after 48 hours; the first 30 seconds is where to look first.